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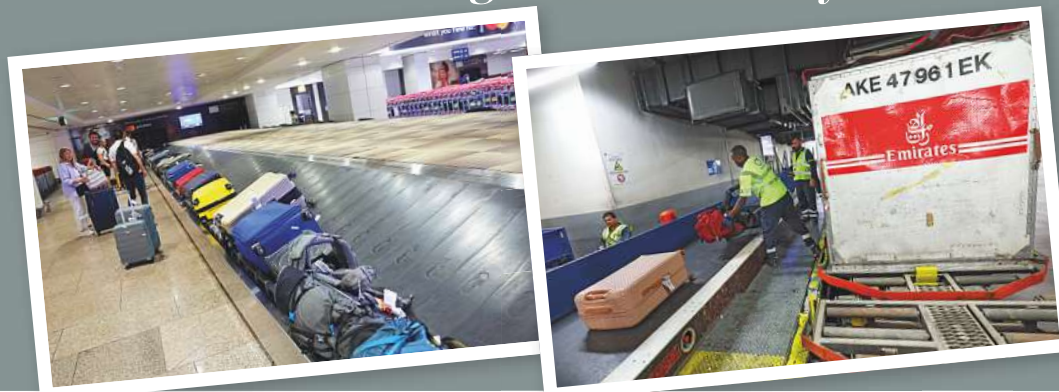
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NATION



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Despite the staggering volume of 63 million bags this year, the airport and the baggage team deliver an astonishing 99.8% accuracy rate | P2



Pics by Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Flying Emirates? Leave power banks at home

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Safety rules for usage of power banks onboard flights is now in full effect, Emirates reaffirmed yesterday.

“Using any kind of power bank is prohibited onboard Emirates’ flights, effective from tomorrow, October 1, 2025,” the Dubai airline stated.

“Emirates provides in-seat charging on all aircraft. However, it still recommends that customers fully charge their devices before flying, especially on longer duration flights.”

The airline said the rule applies across its entire fleet after a safety review highlighted risks linked to lithium battery incidents in aviation.

The airline said rising use of portable chargers has coincided with a growing number of lithium battery-related incidents across the aviation industry.

Power banks, typically powered by lithium-ion or lithium-polymer batteries, pose a fire hazard if damaged or overcharged. In severe cases, a process known as thermal runaway can lead to overheating, fires, or explosions.

Etihad Rail unveils final train designs

Model of sleek silver passenger cabin showcased at global expo in Abu Dhabi

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Editor - Abu Dhabi

Etihad Rail has revealed the final designs of its much-anticipated passenger trains set to launch in the UAE in 2026. The train will connect Abu Dhabi to Dubai in just 57 minutes.

A model of the sleek silver train cabin was showcased at the Global Rail Transport Infrastructure Exhibition and Conference in Abu Dhabi yesterday, featuring Etihad Rail’s distinctive black-and-red logo.

Three classes

Each train will have three classes: Economy, Family and First. Economy will have face-to-face seating in dark grey, while Family will have opposing seats with a table in between. First Class will have wider, adjustable seats with foldable tables behind each seat.

Overhead luggage compart-



First look inside
Etihad Rail's new
passenger trains of
comfort and speed

ments will be available in all cabins, along with designated spaces for larger baggage.

Etihad Rail passengers trains will have two models — Chinese-manufactured CRC coaches will have around 365 seats, while Spanish-built CAF coaches will have 369. Crew and station staff will wear cream and red uniforms, while drivers will be dressed in grey and black.

The first trains are expected to operate at speeds of up to 200km/h.

Accept peace or pay, Trump warns Hamas

ARAB, MUSLIM NATIONS HAIL US
PRESIDENT’S EFFORTS TO END WAR

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump yesterday issued his bluntest warning yet to Hamas, giving the militant group only a few days to accept his 20-point Gaza peace plan — or face what he called severe consequences.

“We have one signature that we need, and that signature will pay in hell if they don’t sign. I hope they sign for their own good and create something really great,” Trump declared, a day after his meeting with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in Washington.

Earlier, he told reporters Hamas had “three or four days” to respond to the deal, which demands the group’s disarmament, the release of hostages within 72 hours, and a staged Israeli withdrawal from Gaza.

Amnesty, but no role

In return, Gaza would be placed under a transitional authority headed by Trump and backed by international oversight. Hamas members pledging peaceful coexistence would be granted amnesty, but the group would be excluded from any future governance role.

Foreign ministers of the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Jordan,

Indonesia, Pakistan, Turkey, Qatar, and Egypt jointly welcomed Trump’s “sincere efforts” to end the war, expressing confidence in his ability to deliver peace.

UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres also urged “all parties” to commit to the deal and reiterated his call for an immediate and permanent ceasefire.

Qatar was set to hold talks with Hamas negotiators, Egypt and Turkey to discuss the plan, and hoped that Hamas would study it “responsibly”.

Qatar and Egypt handed the proposal to Hamas on Monday, and “the (Hamas) negotiating delegation promised to study it responsibly,” foreign ministry spokesman Majed Al Ansari told a press conference.

Netanyahu’s apology

In a parallel development, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu offered a rare apology to Qatar for a recent strike that killed a Qatari serviceman.

Speaking by phone to Qatari Prime Minister Mohammed Bin Abdulrahman Al Thani during a White House visit, Netanyahu expressed “deep regret” for violating Qatari sovereignty, according to a US statement.

He promised no such attack would be repeated.

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